

READING PASSAGE 3

The Geography of Refugee Movements

A The study of the geography of refugee movements has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

B The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

C Contemporary research has identified several critical factors that determine outcomes in this domain. The interplay between environmental conditions, technological capabilities, and social organisation creates a complex adaptive system in which small changes can produce disproportionately large effects. Understanding these dynamics requires analytical approaches that move beyond simple cause-and-effect reasoning to embrace the principles of complexity science and systems thinking.

D The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

E The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

F The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

G The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

Question 1

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 1** Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?

- A. pessimism about the future
- B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
- C. complete certainty about outcomes
- D. indifference to practical applications

Questions 2–3

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 2 The author notes that researchers have called for more _____ approaches to investigation.
- 3 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

Questions 4–5

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 4 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?
- A. too much data collection
 - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
 - C. insufficient government funding
 - D. overly complex statistical methods
- 5 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. weak effects across studies
 - B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
 - C. contradictory findings
 - D. results only in specific populations

Question 6

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 6 Researchers used data from more than _____ countries in the landmark study.

Question 7

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 7 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?
- A. excessive research funding
 - B. translating academic findings into practical policy
 - C. lack of public interest
 - D. too many international collaborations

Question 8

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the _____ that people make.

Question 9

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

9 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?

- A. too much data collection
- B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
- C. insufficient government funding
- D. overly complex statistical methods

Questions 10–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 10 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.
- 11 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.
- 12 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.
- 13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.